

as large a crop. Container-grown canes will also need support—consider growing them against a trellis or intersperse them with bamboo canes and secure plants with string or garden twine. Plant two or three canes per 12 in (30 cm) container.

CROP CARE

Keep canes well-watered, especially during fruiting, bearing in mind that container-grown plants will dry out more quickly than those planted directly in the ground.

Feed with a general, balanced fertilizer in early spring and then mulch with well-rotted manure or compost. Mulch again with straw in early summer. When plants reach



Tie developing stems in to bamboo canes

about 30 in (75 cm) in height, thin them out. Remove any weak or diseased looking canes first. You may need to construct netting to protect the fruits from birds, which can strip a bush in no time.

Prune summer-fruiting types in late summer, as for blackberries (see p.132), after harvesting. Tie in the new growth, and lightly

PESTS AND DISEASES

Although cane spot and fungal leaf spots are a potential problem for raspberries, resistant cultivars are available. Other problems include:

- Birds—use netting to deter them.
- Raspberry beetle and raspberry leaf and bud mite—hoe around the soil to bring them to the soil surface, and cut down stems after fruiting.
- Raspberry viruses—remove and destroy infected canes. Rotate crops.



The virus raspberry cane spot creates purple, white-centered spots on leaves.